Year 5 English | The Wrong Turn

Learn and notice | Build tension through connected events

Aussie Primary Academy | Writing Growth

Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can build tension by making each event change what the character knows or can do.

Model scene: The Wrong Corridor

Tess followed the sound of music, certain it would lead to the rehearsal room. At the end of the corridor, she pushed open a door and found rows of empty chairs. The music stopped.

She checked the room number on her rehearsal note. Room 12. The sign beside her read 21. From the hall, the teacher called that rehearsal would begin in one minute. Tess turned back, but a trolley now blocked the narrow passage.

She could not squeeze past without knocking over the equipment. Instead, she called to the nearby caretaker, who moved the trolley. Tess checked the signs carefully and hurried towards Room 12.

Writing detective

1. What causes Tess's first problem?
2. How does the trolley change the situation?
3. Which action solves the obstacle in a way that fits the scene?

Notice and explain

Event 1: Tess discovers the wrong room.
Event 2: A trolley blocks her return route.
Explain how Event 2 raises the stakes instead of simply adding a random surprise.

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Think and plan | Build tension through connected events

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Your writing task

Write a story about a wrong turn. It may happen at school, during a game or on a trip. Build tension through linked events and resolve the problem. Start new paragraphs when the focus or stage changes.

Goal and wrong turn

What is the character trying to do? Why do they turn the wrong way?

First warning

What detail shows something is wrong?

Growing difficulty

What consequence or obstacle makes the problem harder?

Response

What does the character try? How does it affect what happens next?

Resolution

How does the character get back on track? Use a clue or action already introduced.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write a story about a wrong turn. It may happen at school, during a game or on a trip. Build tension through linked events and resolve the problem. Start new paragraphs when the focus or stage changes.
Useful words: corridor, blocked, rehearsal, obstacle, carefully. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] The wrong turn has a clear cause.
[ ] Each obstacle changes the situation.
[ ] My character responds to the obstacles.
[ ] The resolution follows from the story.

One focused improvement

Before: She was late. Then lots of things happened.
After: The rehearsal was about to begin, but a trolley blocked the passage back to the correct room.
Find a vague or unrelated event. Explain how it affects the character's goal, choices or time.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

She follows the sound instead of checking the room number and reaches Room 21. The trolley blocks her route while rehearsal is about to begin. Calling the caretaker to move it provides a plausible way through. Accept supported interpretations of the time pressure.
Notice task: It stops her returning quickly, so the existing time pressure becomes stronger. The event affects her original goal.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Choose a familiar school setting. Map three events aloud before writing.
Challenge: Use one brief sentence at a tense moment, then explain its effect. Do not sacrifice sentence accuracy.
Ask: What becomes harder after this event? How does the character respond?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: The Wrong Queue. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers. These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E5LY06: developing ideas, organising and linking paragraphs, precise vocabulary and text connectives. Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 5 “Informative text: Bushfires”; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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